

# MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Upper Elementary | Unit 9

## Prefixes con-, com-, co-



Today I am learning that **con-**, **com-** and **co-** often carry the idea *with* or *together*.

### 1 Learn the Meaning

These related prefixes often carry the idea *with* or *together*. Their spelling changes in different words.

**connect** = join together      **combine** = put together  
**cooperate** = work together      **coauthor** = write with another

### 2 Build the Word

The form **co-** can be added to whole words. Build each new word.

| Base word | Prefix | New word | What it means |
|-----------|--------|----------|---------------|
| author    | co-    | _____    | _____         |
| worker    | co-    | _____    | _____         |
| operate   | co-    | _____    | _____         |
| exist     | co-    | _____    | _____         |
| host      | co-    | _____    | _____         |

### 3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

Our group had to **cooperate** to prepare a science display. Mia and Leo agreed to **coauthor** the explanation card while the others built the model. First, they **compared** two designs and **combined** the clearest parts of each. They **connected** labels to the correct diagrams and **communicated** whenever a measurement did not match. Later, Mia and Leo decided to **cohost** the demonstration so they could share the speaking. Before presenting, they **compared** the model with the instructions. The **coauthors** checked the card together while the **cohosts** practised taking turns. Everyone then **combined** their notes into one clear plan. They realised that strong teams **connect** ideas, combine different strengths and **cooperate** instead of working separately.



Highlight the words beginning with **con-**, **com-** or **co-**. What idea do they share?

### 4 Word Detective

Choose one **con-**, **com-** or **co-** word from the passage and investigate it.

- Write the word from the passage.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Which prefix form does it use: **con-**, **com-** or **co-**?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- What does the whole word mean?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- How does its meaning connect to *with* or *together*?  
\_\_\_\_\_

### 5 Sort the Prefixes

Sort each word by the prefix form it uses.

connect      converge      combine      compare      communicate  
cooperate      coauthor      coexist

| con-  | com-  | co-   |
|-------|-------|-------|
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |

### 6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

- We had to \_\_\_\_\_ because \_\_\_\_\_.
- Use a **con-**, **com-** or **co-** word in your own sentence.  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_



#### Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the **con-/com-/co-** prefix family
- ☐ Explains the *with/together* idea
- ☐ Sorts words by the prefix form
- ☐ Reads and uses target words in context



#### Capture idea:

Find a **con-**, **com-** or **co-** word in a book. Record the word and explain its meaning.